Photo Credit: Jason Houston for USAID

CONSERVATION ENTERPRISE IMPACT LAB 2024

HARNESSING A THEORY OF CHANGE FOR EFFECTIVE CONSERVATION ENTERPRISE STRATEGIES

From May to September 2024, nine activity teams—comprising USAID staff and implementing partners—from seven countries across Latin America, Africa, and Asia participated in the fourth iteration of the Conservation Enterprises Impact Lab. During this period, teams collaborated to share their successes and challenges in implementing conservation enterprise approaches. Using the Conservation Enterprise Theory of Change, they focused on necessary adaptations to enhance biodiversity conservation and improve human well-being outcomes. Each team created a poster outlining their activity's theory of change, key assumptions, and valuable lessons learned. This compendium includes all the teams' posters.

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FROM THE AMERICAN PEOPLE

Community-driven enterprises set the stage for sustainability in livelihoods activities in Cambodia

Prathna Preap, Sopheak Hoeun, Va Khiev, Samath Chhith, Matthew Edwardsen

CAMBODIA

TETRA TECH

Community-Based Enterprises (CBE) Types:

- Community Based Ecotour (CBET)
- Agriculture (IBIS Rice, cashews, turmeric)
- Non-Timber Forest Products (wild honey, talipot palm)
- Aquaculture

Conservation Enterprise Approach

USAID Conserve supports community-based organizations (CBO) to decide which community-based enterprises (CBE) are best for their context. Once selected, Conserve provides the CBOs with the appropriate skills and private sector connections to enable a sustainable conservation enterprise approach.

THEORY OF CHANGE

Support Conservation Enterprises

ACTIVITIES
USAID Conserve supports community based organizations (CBO) committees with technical and financial capacity building. The project also supports CBOs to develop small grant proposals and understand the feasibility of expanding existing local enterprises or looking for new products to develop.

Enabling Conditions in Place for Enterprises

ASSUMPTION
Supporting CBOs to understand the feasibility of different enterprises, fill capacity gaps, and find capital allows community-driven enterprise selection and better alignment with community needs (rather than outsiders selecting the enterprises).

KEY LESSONS
It is beneficial to consider a range of local markets (3-5 per community) rather than solely focusing on niche international markets.

Benefits Realized by Stakeholders

ASSUMPTION
Social enterprises or private sector partners provide technical support and offer premier prices to compliant CBE members.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Income & conservation agreements through Environmental Review Checklist and Environmental Report Form (ERC/ERF).

KEY LESSONS
CBE members are willing to reinvest a portion of their profit into conservation activities. For example, in the case of wild honey – 5-10% of income goes into patrols and a portion of CBET income is contributed to forestry/fishery conservation.

Stakeholders' Attitudes and Behaviors Changed

ASSUMPTION
CBE members follow complaint guidelines, environmental- friendly techniques and contribute to conservation activities. Income from CBE reduces dependence on unsustainable harvest of natural resources.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Compliance with agreements through an Internal Control System and external quality inspection or product certification.

KEY LESSONS
CBE members comply and use sustainable techniques when buyers offer premium prices.

Threat Reduction or Restoration

ASSUMPTION
Because communities earn increased income from ecotourism or from complying with agreements, they are more invested in restoring the ecosystems and reducing hunting/ logging pressures to ensure the sustainability of the income source.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Annual income record, presence of conservation signboards, and engagement with bird nest protection.

KEY LESSONS
Loggers and hunters recognize that it's easier and more reliable to make money through conservation enterprises and just need the opportunity to engage to make the livelihood shift.

Biodiversity Conservation

ASSUMPTION
At risk habitats like Tonle Sap and endangered species like the softshell turtle and ibis are protected due to the increased income and direct payments that enterprise participants receive from complying with agreements developed through the enterprise process.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Bird nest protection.

KEY LESSONS
Communities understand the link between restored and conserved species and their livelihoods.

Photo Credit: Prathna Preap

USAID
FROM THE AMERICAN PEOPLE

Local communities and national companies recover tropical dry forest and increase resilience to climate change by adopting Nature-Based Solutions in the cocoa value chain

Andres Rueda, Daniel Ruiz

COLOMBIA

Grupo nutresa ASOSEYNEKUN

Enterprise Types

- Cacao produced with Nature-based Solutions (NbS)

Conservation Enterprise Approach

The *Programa Naturaleza Productiva* (Productive Nature Program, 2023-2028) promotes alliances between the private sector and rural communities with the purpose of conserving biodiversity, preserving environmental services, and improving the well-being of rural communities. Through a Market Systems strategy, *Naturaleza Productiva* seeks to positively influence the business models of companies such as Nutresa and producer associations through the implementation of Nature-based Solutions (NbS) in various value chains in sectors such as cosmetics, energy and agriculture, as well as cocoa.

THEORY OF CHANGE

Support Conservation Enterprises → Enabling Conditions in Place for Enterprises → Benefits Realized by Stakeholders → Stakeholders' Attitudes and Behaviors Changed → Threat Reduction or Restoration → Biodiversity Conservation

Support Conservation Enterprises

ACTIVITIES

Partners support:
-Capacity building and support in the design and implementation of nature-based solutions for cocoa Production Associations.
-Cost-efficiency analysis of NbS use to promote biodiversity conservation as a key part of the anchor company's business model.
-Signing of conservation agreements and commercial agreements to strengthen the link between these two parts of the value chain.

Enabling Conditions in Place for Enterprises

ASSUMPTION
Nutresa provides technical assistance that includes farm-level planning, identification of ecosystem services and a scaling-up strategy.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Whether the technical assistance approach includes farm-level planning using a survey that captures farm characterization.

KEY LESSONS
It is necessary to demonstrate to producers that what happens in the ecosystem affects their productivity and their productivity depends on the ecosystem.

Benefits Realized by Stakeholders

ASSUMPTION
An agroforestry/cocoa model that preserves ecological connectivity and ecosystem services generates better economic benefits, greater resilience to climate change, greater income diversification, and more production stability than a model without agroforestry and ecosystem services.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Stratified sampling to measure, compare and contrast economic, environmental and social benefits on farms.

KEY LESSONS
Producers have a low perception of the risks posed by climate change. This impacts their valuation of the NbS model and motivation to change their behavior.

Stakeholders' Attitudes and Behaviors Changed

ASSUMPTION
Producers see their land beyond cocoa cultivation, understand and value ecosystem services and their relationship with the productive activity, and adopt NbS with a view of the landscape.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Semi-structured interviews and focus groups to understand the emotions and perceptions of producers and Nutresa and a stratified and random sampling to measure the results of NbS implementation.

KEY LESSONS
Market pressures help motivate producer families to conserve while producing, but legal regulation is insufficient and does not seem to be an efficient way to avoid, for example, the expansion of the agricultural frontier.

Threat Reduction or Restoration

ASSUMPTION
As farm management and productivity improve, farmers do not increase the agricultural frontier, use fewer chemical inputs, and stop deforesting riparian forests.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Implementation of NbS and sustainable practices and conservation agreements, ha under better management.

KEY LESSONS
Farms that implement NbS are better able to withstand prolonged periods of drought, which normally occur in the tropical dry forest, and have better access to water and maintain better soil moisture.

Biodiversity Conservation

ASSUMPTION
More forest cover in the tropical dry forest, recovery of riparian forests, soil and water improvement.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Use mapping analysis to measure ecological connectivity of remnant dry forest cores. Measure the presence of pollinators as a bioindicator of ecosystem health.

KEY LESSONS
There are farms that already have conservation practices in place, although more time is needed to draw conclusions.

Photo Credit: Productive Nature

Comunidades locales y empresas nacionales recuperan el bosque seco tropical y aumentan resiliencia al cambio climático por la adopción de soluciones basadas en la naturaleza en la cadena de valor de cacao

Andres Rueda, Daniel Ruiz

COLOMBIA

Tipos de Empresas

- Cacao producido con soluciones basadas en la naturaleza (SbN)

Estrategia de empresa de conservación

El Programa Naturaleza Productiva (2023-2028) fomenta alianzas entre el sector privado y las comunidades rurales con el propósito de conservar la biodiversidad, preservar los servicios ambientales y mejorar el bienestar de las comunidades rurales. A través de una estrategia de Sistemas de Mercado, Naturaleza Productiva busca incidir positivamente en los modelos de negocio de empresas como Nutresa y en asociaciones de productores a través de la implementación de Soluciones Basadas en la Naturaleza (SbN) en diversas cadenas de valor de sectores como el cosmético, energía y agrícola, como el cacao.

TEORÍA DEL CAMBIO

Apoyo a las empresas de conservación → **Condiciones favorables para las empresas** → **Beneficios obtenidos por las partes interesadas** → **Cambio en el comportamiento y actitud de las partes interesadas** → **Amenazas reducidas para la biodiversidad (o su restauración)** → **Conservación de la biodiversidad**

Apoyo a las empresas de conservación

ACTIVIDADES

Socios apoyan:

-Fortalecimiento de capacidades y apoyo en el diseño e implementación de soluciones basadas en la naturaleza de las Asociaciones Productivas de cacao.

-Análisis de costo-eficiencia de uso de SbN para fomentar la conservación de la biodiversidad como parte clave del modelo de negocio de la empresa ancla.

-Firma de acuerdos de conservación y acuerdos comerciales para fortalecer el vínculo entre estas dos partes de la cadena de valor.

Condiciones favorables para las empresas

SUPOSICIÓN

Nutresa provee asistencia técnica que incluye planificación al nivel de finca, identificación de servicios ecosistémicos y una estrategia de escalamiento.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA

Si el enfoque de asistencia técnica incluye planificación al nivel de finca utilizando una encuesta que captura caracterización de predios.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES

Es necesario demostrar a productores que lo que pasa en el ecosistema afecta su productividad y su productividad depende del ecosistema.

Beneficios obtenidos por las partes interesadas

SUPOSICIÓN

Un modelo agroforestal/cacao que conserva la conectividad ecológica y los servicios ecosistémicos genera mejores beneficios económicos, mayor resiliencia frente al cambio climático, mayor diversificación de ingreso, y más estabilidad de producción que un modelo sin agroforestería y sin servicios ecosistémicos.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA

Muestreo estratificado para medir, comparar y contrastar beneficios económicos, ambientales, y sociales en las fincas.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES

Productores tienen una baja percepción de los riesgos que representa el cambio climático. Eso impacta su valoración del modelo de SbN y motivación de cambiar su comportamientos.

Cambio en el comportamiento y actitud de las partes interesadas

SUPOSICIÓN

Productores ven su predio más allá del cultivo de cacao, entienden y valoran los servicios ecosistémicos y su relación con la actividad productiva, y adoptan SbN con vista del paisaje.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA

Entrevistas semiestructuradas y grupos focales para entender las emociones y percepciones de los productores y Nutresa y un muestreo estratificado y aleatorio para medir resultado de la implementación de SbN.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES

Las presiones de mercado ayudan a motivar a las familias productoras a conservar mientras producen, pero la regulación legal es insuficiente y no parece ser un camino eficiente para evitar, por ejemplo, el aumento de la frontera agrícola.

Amenazas reducidas para la biodiversidad (o su restauración)

SUPOSICIÓN

Mientras el manejo y la productividad de los predios mejoran, los productores no aumentan la frontera agrícola, utilizan menos insumos químicos, y dejan de deforestar los bosques riparios.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA

La implementación de SbN y prácticas sostenibles y acuerdos de conservación, ha bajo mejor manejo.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES

Fincas que implementan SbN resisten mejor a periodos prolongados de sequía, que normalmente ocurren en el bosque seco tropical y tienen mejor acceso a agua y mantienen una mejor humedad en sus suelos.

Conservación de la biodiversidad

SUPOSICIÓN

Más cobertura forestal del bosque seco tropical, recuperación de bosques de ribera, mejoramientos de suelos y aguas.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA

Usar análisis cartográfico para medir la conectividad ecológica de los núcleos remanentes de bosque seco. Medir la presencia de polinizadores como bioindicador de la salud del ecosistema.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES

Existen predios que ya tienen prácticas de conservación aunque se requiere más tiempo para sacar conclusiones.

Crédito de foto: Productive Nature

"Fishing with History": Generating demand for sustainable fishing through responsible seafood enterprises

Félix Burgos, Carlos Silva, Nicolás Zapata, Cesar Viteri

ECUADOR

Enterprise Types
- Sustainable fishing
- Gastronomy products

Conservation Enterprise Approach
Support seafood enterprises with a business model aligned with a vision of sustainability in the management of fishery resources and responsible fishing. The business model identifies a value proposition based on four types of returns: economic, social, environmental, and inspirational. The demand generated by these ventures motivates responsible fishing. In Galápagos the ban on shark and ray fishing is enforced, and on the mainland, measures are implemented to reduce shark and ray mortality, as well as to progressively reduce bycatch levels.

THEORY OF CHANGE

Support Conservation Enterprises

ACTIVITIES
Creating and strengthening a community of seafood system enterprises, support networks and training. Working with fishermen's associations and cooperatives to use alternative, low environmental impact fishing gear, and direct access to markets that value shark-free fishery products.

Enabling Conditions in Place for Enterprises

ASSUMPTION
Fishermen have greater negotiating capacity with intermediaries, traders or potential clients and access to a system of "*lonjas*" (more direct markets with sustainable fishing standards). Entrepreneurs in Galápagos have knowledge of accounting and access to inputs in their production chain, such as glass containers and labels.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Review of forms (e.g., Excel file or notebook for recording accounting information) filled out by and with the entrepreneurs/participants and monitor the availability or scarcity of inputs in Galápagos.

KEY LESSONS
Reaching agreements with the public institutions and finding the appropriate legal path for the establishment of the "lonjas" is complex and requires a negotiation path, which allows to find the common interest among the intervening actors.

Benefits Realized by Stakeholders

ASSUMPTION
Commercialization through the "*lonjas*" will allow fishermen to access better prices by reducing intermediaries and complying with sustainable fishing standards. Entrepreneurs receive fair prices for their sustainable products and benefit from being part of a community of entrepreneurs.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Fish and seafood market prices and profitability margins.

KEY LESSONS
Analyzing the impact generated by the ventures, based on the 4 Returns (natural, environmental, social and financial) has allowed the entrepreneurs to become aware of impacts that they had not previously visualized and that now empowers them as generators of change.

Stakeholders' Attitudes and Behaviors Changed

ASSUMPTION
Sustainable seafood ventures generate sufficient demand to raise the value of sustainable fishing, encouraging fishermen to use alternative gear that reduces shark bycatch. Ventures serve as an inspiration to others, generating systemic change.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Volume of seafood products passing through the fish markets, demand for fishing by entrepreneurs, perceptions of fishermen regarding access to fish markets and of entrepreneurs.

KEY LESSONS
Generating changes in the livelihoods of fishing communities is a great challenge; programs must consider aspects of the participants such as gender, entrepreneurial intention, risk appetite (financial), customs, among others (see for example Avila-Forcada et al., 2020).

Threat Reduction or Restoration

ASSUMPTION
The use of alternative fishing gear and traceability technologies results in lower shark bycatch and reduced shark mortality.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
The use of alternative fishing gear.

KEY LESSONS
Implementing traceability technologies for artisanal fisheries is feasible; however, it is necessary to identify markets that are willing to pay more for traceable fish, and whose commitment to fishermen and entrepreneurs is medium and long term.

Biodiversity Conservation

ASSUMPTION
20% reduction in shark bycatch. Reduce shark and ray bycatch mortality.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Bycatch and/or mortality rates of sharks and rays.

KEY LESSONS
Too early.

Photo Credit: Habla Tiburón

“Pesca con historia”: Generando demanda para una pesca sostenible a través de emprendimientos de alimentos del mar responsables

Félix Burgos, Carlos Silva, Nicolás Zapata, Cesar Viteri

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Fundación Charles Darwin Foundation WWF

Tipos de Empresas
- Pesca sostenible
- Productos gastronómicos

Estrategia de empresa de conservación
Apoyar emprendimientos del sistema de alimentos del mar con un Modelo de Negocios alineado con una visión de sostenibilidad en el manejo recursos pesqueros y pesca responsable. El Modelo de negocios identifica una propuesta de valor basada en cuatro tipo de retornos: económicos, sociales, ambientales y de inspiración. La demanda generada por estos emprendimientos motiva la pesca responsable: en Galápagos se cumple con la prohibición de pesca de tiburones y rayas, y en el continente se aplican medidas para reducir la mortalidad de tiburones y rayas, así como reducir progresivamente los niveles de pesca incidental.

TEORÍA DEL CAMBIO

Apoyo a las empresas de conservación → **Condiciones favorables para las empresas** → **Beneficios obtenidos por las partes interesadas** → **Cambio en el comportamiento y actitud de las partes interesadas** → **Amenazas reducidas para la biodiversidad (o su restauración)** → **Conservación de la biodiversidad**

Apoyo a las empresas de conservación

ACTIVIDADES
Creación y fortalecimiento de una comunidad de emprendimientos del sistema de alimentos del mar, redes de apoyo y capacitación. Trabajar con asociaciones y cooperativas de pescadores para usar artes de pesca alternativos y de bajo impacto ambiental, y acceder directamente a mercados que valoren los productos pesqueros libres de tiburón.

Condiciones favorables para las empresas

SUPOSICIÓN
Pescadores tienen mayor capacidad de negociación con el intermediario, el comerciante o clientes potenciales y acceso a un sistema de “lonjas” (mercados más directos y con estándares de pesca sostenible). Emprendedores en Galápagos tienen conocimientos en contabilidad y acceso a los insumos en su cadena de producción, tales como envases de vidrio, y etiquetas.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
Se revisan los formatos (ej.: archivo Excel o cuaderno de registro de información contable) llenados por y junto a los emprendedores/participantes y monitorea la disponibilidad o escasez de insumos en galápagos.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
Llegar a acuerdos con las instituciones públicas y encontrar la vía legal adecuada para el establecimiento de las “lonjas” es compleja y requiere una vía de negociación, la cual permita encontrar el interés común entre los actores intervinientes.

Beneficios obtenidos por las partes interesadas

SUPOSICIÓN
Comercialización a través de las “lonjas” permitirá acceder a los pescadores a mejores precios a través de la reducción de intermediarios y el cumplimiento de estándares de pesca sostenible. Emprendedores reciben precios justos para su productos sostenibles y se benefician por ser parte de una comunidad de emprendedores.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
Precios de comercialización de pescado y productos de alimentos de mar, y márgenes de rentabilidad.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
Analizar el impacto que generan los emprendimientos, en torno los 4 Retornos (natural, ambiental, social y financiero) ha permitido que los emprendedores sean conscientes de impactos que antes no tenían visualizados y que ahora los empodera como generadores de cambio.

Cambio en el comportamiento y actitud de las partes interesadas

SUPOSICIÓN
Emprendimientos de alimentos del mar sostenibles generan una demanda suficiente para elevar el valor de la pesca sostenible, incentivando al pescador a usar artes alternativos que reduzcan la captura incidental de tiburón. Emprendimientos sirven como inspiración para otros, generando un cambio sistémico.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
Volumen de productos del mar que pasan por la lonjas, demanda de pesca por parte de emprendimientos, percepciones de pescadores respecto al acceso a las lonjas y de emprendedores.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
Generar cambios en los medios de vida de las comunidades pesqueras es un gran desafío; los programas deben considerar aspectos de los participantes como género, intención de emprender, apetito al riesgo (financiero), costumbres,, entre otros (ver por ejemplo Avila-Forcada et al., 2020).

Amenazas reducidas para la biodiversidad (o su restauración)

SUPOSICIÓN
El uso de artes de pesca alternativos y tecnologías de trazabilidad resulta en una menor captura incidental de tiburones, así como en la reducción de su mortalidad.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
El uso de artes de pesca alternativos.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
Implementar las tecnologías de trazabilidad de la pesca artesanal es factible; sin embargo, se requiere identificar mercados que estén dispuestos a pagar más por pesca con trazabilidad, y cuyo compromiso con pescadores y emprendedores sea de mediano y largo plazo.

Conservación de la biodiversidad

SUPOSICIÓN
Reducción del 20% de la captura incidental de tiburones
Reducir la mortalidad por la pesca incidental de tiburones y rayas.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
Tasas de captura incidental y/o mortalidad de tiburones y rayas.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
Demasiado temprano.

Crédito de foto: Habla Tiburón

Conserving the natural and cultural heritage of the Ecuadorian Amazon through value chains based on ancestral production systems.

Lili Riofrio, Rodrigo Gehot

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Enterprise Types

- Cacao
- Bamboo

Conservation Enterprise Approach

The SACHA Project (2023-2028) seeks to promote bioeconomy value chains with a market focus and ancestral production systems where existing and new producer organizations will be strengthened, if necessary, for the sustainability of family and associative businesses and economies, as a mechanism to promote the conservation of the natural and cultural heritage of the Ecuadorian Amazon. The bioeconomy strategy focuses on local capacity building and empowerment processes from the grassroots and outside of political issues and organizations. The project seeks to involve men, women and young people, fostering intergenerational management and promoting horizontal and collaborative relationships between bioenterprises and strategic alliances with the private sector and academia.

THEORY OF CHANGE

Support Conservation Enterprises → Enabling Conditions in Place for Enterprises → Benefits Realized by Stakeholders → Stakeholders' Attitudes and Behaviors Changed → Threat Reduction or Restoration → Biodiversity Conservation

Support Conservation Enterprises

ACTIVITIES

Partners support:
-Strengthening of cacao and bamboo value chains.
-Training and empowerment of producers in socio-organizational and socio-business management and good practices for sustainability.
-Promotion of relationships and agreements between producers and private sector companies.
-Provision of inputs, tools and infrastructure required to strengthen production chains.
-Quality management, traceability, and certifications to link product associations to private companies and market niches.

Enabling Conditions in Place for Enterprises

ASSUMPTION

Producers form non-political associations, have commercial agreements and respectful relationships with the private sector, such as Valenco, and achieve the volumes and quality levels agreed with the company.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

The capabilities and level of empowerment of bioentrepreneurship through their reporting and performance in their functions.

KEY LESSONS

It is important to involve young people and various age groups in these local capacity building processes and to encourage them through the exchange of local experiences that have a transforming and inspiring power.

Benefits Realized by Stakeholders

ASSUMPTION

Producer associations access specialized markets with sustainability criteria in which they receive fair prices/higher incomes, receive support, technical assistance, and training from the private sector, and the adoption of sustainable practices results in savings in inputs and time, which gives flexibility to use time for other activities to maintain a steady income stream.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

The quantities of cacao that can be produced in the territory, the quantities sold to intermediaries and Valenco and their prices (this is a traceability mechanism).

KEY LESSONS

It is necessary to work on training and raising awareness of both producer organizations and companies, as each must be made aware of the tangible benefits of these new business models, reducing the gaps between producers and companies.

Stakeholders' Attitudes and Behaviors Changed

ASSUMPTION

Associations of cacao producers use efficient production systems (agroforestry systems) where intensive cultivation and the use of resistant species, including local varieties, prevail. They understand the negative externalities of using toxic inputs and stop using these products. Communities use bamboo instead of harvesting timber.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Through conversations, research, and observation, they monitor the adoption of agroforestry systems, the use of pesticides, and the relationship between companies and producer associations.

KEY LESSONS

Changing behaviors and attitudes is a long-term process and not an immediate one, that requires commitment, participation, and real involvement of the communities in these initiatives.

Threat Reduction or Restoration

ASSUMPTION

When farms are established under the agroforestry system, there is a reduction in the expansion of the agricultural frontier, poaching, the application of chemical inputs in plantations and the promotion of monocultures. The use of bamboo reduces selective timber extraction.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

The expansion of cocoa farms through geographic information systems.

KEY LESSONS

These conservation projects do not fully address all the needs faced by the communities, as they are part of the broader context of a country-wide socio-economic crisis. These communities are directly affected, their needs are increasing and they tend to combine sustainable and non-sustainable alternatives to try to meet their basic needs.

Biodiversity Conservation

ASSUMPTION

Agroforestry systems increase forest cover and avoid the presence of monocultures.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Presence of biodiverse species.

KEY LESSONS

In some places, these efforts can contribute to a certain degree of forest restoration, but when it comes to hunting, it is complex because the species have disappeared.

Photo Credit: SACHA

Conservando el patrimonio natural y cultural de la Amazonia Ecuatoriana a través de cadenas de valor basadas en sistemas de producción ancestrales

Lili Riofrio, Rodrigo Gehot

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Tipos de Empresas:
- Cacao
- Bambú

Estrategia de empresa de conservación

El Proyecto SACHA (2023-2028) busca promover cadenas de valor de la bioeconomía con enfoque de mercado y sistemas de producción ancestrales donde se fortalecerán las organizaciones de productores/as existentes y nuevas, si fuera necesario, para la sostenibilidad de los negocios y economías familiares y asociativas, como mecanismo para fomentar la conservación del patrimonio natural y cultural de la Amazonía Ecuatoriana. La estrategia de bioeconomía apuesta a procesos de fortalecimiento de capacidades locales y empoderamiento desde las bases y al margen de los temas y organizaciones políticas. Se pretende el involucramiento de hombres, mujeres, jóvenes fomentando una gestión intergeneracional y promoviendo relaciones horizontales y colaborativas entre los bioemprendimientos y las alianzas del estratégicas con el sector privado y la academia.

TEORÍA DEL CAMBIO

Apoyo a las empresas de conservación → **Condiciones favorables para las empresas** → **Beneficios obtenidos por las partes interesadas** → **Cambio en el comportamiento y actitud de las partes interesadas** → **Amenazas reducidas para la biodiversidad (o su restauración)** → **Conservación de la biodiversidad**

Apoyo a las empresas de conservación

ACTIVIDADES:
Socios apoyan:
-fortalecimiento de cadenas de valor de cacao y bambú
-capacitación y empoderamiento de productores/as en temas de gestión socio-organizativa, socio empresarial, y buenas prácticas para la sostenibilidad
-fomento de relaciones y acuerdos entre productores/as y empresas del sector privado
-proveimiento de insumos, herramientas, infraestructura que sea requerido para fortalecer las cadenas productivas
-gestionamiento de calidad, trazabilidad, y certificaciones para vincular las asociaciones de productos a empresas privadas y a nichos de mercado.

Condiciones favorables para las empresas

SUPOSICIÓN
Productores/as forman asociaciones no políticas, tienen acuerdos comerciales y relaciones respetuosas con el sector privado, como la empresa Valenco, y logran los volúmenes y niveles de calidad convenido con la empresa.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
Las capacidades y nivel de empoderamiento de los bioemprendimientos a través de sus informes y desempeño en sus funciones.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
Es importante involucrar a los jóvenes y también diversos grupos etarios en estos procesos de fortalecimiento de capacidades locales e incentivarlos a través de **los intercambios de experiencias locales** que tienen un poder transformador e inspirador.

Beneficios obtenidos por las partes interesadas

SUPOSICIÓN
Asociaciones de productores/as acceden a mercados especializados con criterios de sostenibilidad en cual reciben precios justos/ingresos superiores, reciben acompañamiento, asistencia tecnica, y capacitación del sector privado, y la adopción de prácticas sostenibles resulta en ahorros en insumos y tiempo, lo que da flexibilidad para uso de tiempo en otras actividades para mantener un flujo de ingresos constantes.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
Las cantidades de cacao que es posible producir en el territorio, las cantidades vendidas a los intermediarios y a Valenco y sus precios (es un mecanismo de trazabilidad).

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
Es necesario trabajar en la capacitación y sensibilización tanto de las organizaciones productoras como de las empresas, ya que cada uno debe ser concienciado acerca de los beneficios tangibles de estos nuevos modelos de negocios, reduciendo las brechas entre los productores y las empresas.

Cambio en el comportamiento y actitud de las partes interesadas

SUPOSICIÓN
Asociaciones de productores de cacao usan sistemas de producción eficientes (sistemas agroforestales) donde priman cultivos intensivos y el uso de especies resistentes, incluyendo variedades locales, entiendan las externalidades negativas del uso de insumos tóxicos y paran de usar estos productos. Comunidades usan bambú en vez de extraer madera.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
Con conversaciones, investigación, y observacion, monitorean la adopción de sistemas agroforestales, el uso de insumos tóxicos, y la relación entre las empresas y las asociaciones de productores/as.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
Cambiar comportamientos y actitudes es un proceso a largo plazo y no inmediato que requiere de compromiso, participación y un involucramiento real de las comunidades en estas iniciativas.

Amenazas reducidas para la biodiversidad (o su restauración)

SUPOSICIÓN
Al instalarse fincas bajo el sistema agroforestal, hay una reducción en la ampliación de la frontera agrícola, la cacería furtiva, la aplicación de insumos químicos en las plantaciones y promoción de monocultivos. El uso de bambú reduce la extracción de madera selectiva.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
La ampliación de las fincas de cacao a traves de sistemas de información geográfica.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
Estos proyectos de conservación no logran resolver en su totalidad todas las necesidades que enfrentan las comunidades, ya que son parte del contexto más amplio de una crisis socioeconómica a nivel de país. Estas comunidades son afectadas directamente, sus necesidades cada vez son mayores por lo que suelen combinar entre las alternativas sostenibles y las que no lo son para tratar de responder a sus necesidades básicas.

Conservación de la biodiversidad

SUPOSICIÓN
Sistemas agroforestales aumentan cobertura forestal y evitan la presencia de monocultivos.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
Presencia de especies de biodiversidad.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
En ciertos lugares, estos esfuerzos pueden contribuir a que el bosque se restaure en cierta medida, pero cuando se habla de cacería es complejo ya que las especies han desaparecido.

Crédito de foto: SACHA

USAID FROM THE AMERICAN PEOPLE

Strengthening sustainable livelihoods and rescuing ancestral flavors through gastronomy

ECUADOR

Oscar Luna, Margoth Elizalde, Rodrigo Mena, Juan Francisco Marañon

WWF

Enterprise Types

- Educational institutions
- Food development laboratory
- Cafeteria
- Seed capital companies

Conservation Enterprise Approach

Support sustainable and profitable livelihoods with Amazonian communities using a gastronomic model that boosts the economy of Indigenous populations and communities. This model rescues ancestral flavors of the area through conservation agreements, technical assistance, purchase of raw materials, chefs' school for young people, and gourmet sales/marketing of dishes.

THEORY OF CHANGE

Support Conservation Enterprises → **Enabling Conditions in Place for Enterprises** → **Benefits Realized by Stakeholders** → **Stakeholders' Attitudes and Behaviors Changed** → **Threat Reduction or Restoration** → **Biodiversity Conservation**

Support Conservation Enterprises

ACTIVITIES
Conservation agreements with raw material producers, culinary school with young people, mobile lab for dish ideas, financing hub, seed capital, linkage with the private sector, market analysis to identify market niches.

Enabling Conditions in Place for Enterprises

ASSUMPTION
Producers have the capacity to adopt sustainable practices and produce good quality products that satisfy a niche in the market, and have formal agreements to sell and guarantee supply.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Number of producers trained in food handling and safety. Number of commercial agreements signed with companies and/or businesses. Number of procedures and/or quality manuals developed by each enterprise.

KEY LESSONS
Market requirements are often very strict, which makes it difficult for producers to meet them, often volumes are not met and the market is lost.

Benefits Realized by Stakeholders

ASSUMPTION
Economic returns improve the quality of life for producers, young chefs, and their families. Having a profession increases young people's self-esteem and leadership, and rescuing traditional products supports community food security and promotes conservation processes.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Amount of sales, number of agreements between communities and companies, number of families that improve their income as a result of SELVA activities.

KEY LESSONS
Creating a model with the involvement of the private sector in which the distribution of benefits improves well-being for the various stakeholders is sustainable.

Stakeholders' Attitudes and Behaviors Changed

ASSUMPTION
Producer families use sustainable production practices, maintain *chakras* and traditional crops, stop clearing the forest for African palm, and act as spokespersons/scalers for the importance of caring for the forests.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Number of conservation agreements signed.

KEY LESSONS
Depending on each type of stakeholder in the territory, there may be differentiated behavioral change strategies, for example, land management and decision making for conservation agreements is different between mestizo and Indigenous communities.

Threat Reduction or Restoration

ASSUMPTION
The expansion of the agricultural frontier and African palm production is reduced and hunting is minimized.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Number of hectares under agroforestry systems and conserved or restored.

KEY LESSONS
A clear baseline and knowledge of the territory is required.

Biodiversity Conservation

ASSUMPTION
Increase of conserved zones in areas that have no conservation status.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW
Number of hectares under conservation agreements.

KEY LESSONS
Take advantage of the diversity of products that exist in the Amazon, which generate income and contribute to maintaining conservation agreements.

Photo Credit: SELVA

Fortaleciendo medios de vida sostenibles y rescatando sabores ancestrales a través de la gastronomía

Oscar Luna, Margoth Elizalde, Rodrigo Mena, Juan Francisco Marañon

ECUADOR

Tipos de Empresas
- Instituciones educativas
- Laboratorio de desarrollo de alimentos
- Cafetería
- Empresas de capital semilla

Estrategia de empresa de conservación
Apoyar medios de vida sostenibles y rentables con comunidades amazónicas usando un modelo gastronómico que dinamice la economía de las poblaciones indígenas y comunidades. Este modelo rescata sabores ancestrales propios de la zona a través de acuerdos de conservación, asistencia técnica, compra de materia prima, escuela de chefs para los jóvenes y venta/comercialización gourmet de platos de cocina.

TEORÍA DEL CAMBIO

Apoyo a las empresas de conservación → Condiciones favorables para las empresas → Beneficios obtenidos por las partes interesadas → Cambio en el comportamiento y actitud de las partes interesadas → Amenazas reducidas para la biodiversidad (o su restauración) → Conservación de la biodiversidad

Apoyo a las empresas de conservación

ACTIVIDADES
Acuerdos de conservación con productores de materia prima, escuela de gastronomía con jovenes, lab móvil de ideas de platos, hub de financiamiento, capital semilla, vinculación con sector privado, análisis de mercado para identificar nichos de mercado

Condiciones favorables para las empresas

SUPOSICIÓN
Productores tienen capacidad para adoptar prácticas sostenibles y producir productos de buena calidad que satisfacen un nicho en el mercado, y tienen acuerdos formales para vender y garantizar el aprovisionamiento.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
Número de productores capacitados en manipulación e inocuidad de alimentos. Número de acuerdos comerciales suscritos con empresa y/o negocios. Número de procedimientos y/o manuales de calidad desarrollados por cada emprendimiento.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
Las exigencias del mercado suelen ser muy estrictas, lo que dificulta a los productores poder cumplirlas. Muchas veces los volúmenes no son alcanzados y se pierde el mercado.

Beneficios obtenidos por las partes interesadas

SUPOSICIÓN
Réditos económicos mejoran la calidad de vida para los productores, los jóvenes chefs, y sus familias. Tener una profesión aumenta el autoestima y liderazgo de los jóvenes, y el rescate de productos tradicionales apoya la seguridad alimentaria de la comunidad y promueve procesos de conservación.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
Monto de venta, número de acuerdos entre comunidades y empresas, número de familias que mejoran sus ingresos como resultado de las actividades de SELVA.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
Crear un modelo con el involucramiento del sector privado en el que la distribución de los beneficios generan bienestar para los diversos actores es sostenible.

Cambio en el comportamiento y actitud de las partes interesadas

SUPOSICIÓN
Familias de productores usan prácticas sostenibles de producción, mantienen chakras y cultivos tradicionales, dejan de deforestar el bosque para palma africana, y actúan como voceros/escaladores de la importancia de cuidar los bosques.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
Número de acuerdos de conservación suscritos.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
En función de cada tipo de actor en territorio puede existir estrategias de cambio de comportamiento diferenciadas, por ejemplo, el manejo y toma de decisión respecto a la tierra, para acuerdos de conservación, es diferente entre comunidades mestizas y comunidades indígenas.

Amenazas reducidas para la biodiversidad (o su restauración)

SUPOSICIÓN
Se reduce la expansión de la frontera agrícola y la producción de palma africana y minimiza la caza.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
Número de hectáreas bajo sistemas agroforestales y conservadas o restauradas.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
Se requiere una línea base clara y conocimiento del territorio.

Conservación de la biodiversidad

SUPOSICIÓN
Aumento de zonas conservadas en áreas que no tienen estatus de conservación.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA
Número de hectáreas bajo acuerdos de conservación.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES
Aprovechar la diversidad de productos que existen en la Amazonía, que generan ingresos y contribuyen a mantener los acuerdos de conservación.

Crédito de foto: SELVA

Improving livelihoods through the promotion of biotrade activities

Zulma Ricord de Mendoza, Zelma Larios Murillo

USAID FROM THE AMERICAN PEOPLE

EL SALVADOR / CENTROAMERICA REGIONAL

ARCAS GOAL MOPAWI DEFENSORES DE LA NATURALEZA unes IUCN

Enterprise Types

- Sustainable fisheries
- Mangrove Honey
- Nature Tourism

Conservation Enterprise Approach

The Regional Coastal Biodiversity Project improves livelihoods and reduces threats to coastal marine ecosystems in El Salvador, Honduras and Guatemala by opening up new economic opportunities based on sustainable natural resource management. Specifically, the project promotes biocommerce, improved governance, landscape management and communication, and social inclusion as strategies to achieve local prosperity in the transboundary coastal ecosystems of Guatemala, Honduras and El Salvador.

THEORY OF CHANGE

Support Conservation Enterprises

ACTIVITIES

Train more than 1,500 people in association management and cooperativism, local tourism, small business management, climate change impacts, good fishing practices and a gender approach; form small savings banks; present evidence of benefits of good natural resource management; develop value chains; cash for work for mangrove restoration/canal dredging, measurement of CO2 sequestration.

Enabling Conditions in Place for Enterprises

ASSUMPTION

Women and young people participate in the companies, there is a culture of collaboration and the laws encourage the good management of forests such as mangroves.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Participation of women in leadership positions and decision-making on ecosystems and species.

KEY LESSONS

Including women and young people improves the effectiveness of the enterprises: Women do important work in fishing/marketing and young people have a better command of social and technological networks.

Benefits Realized by Stakeholders

ASSUMPTION

Training and best practices result in greater empowerment, security, leadership, and income for women and other members of the enterprises, increased self-worth as useful people in their families and communities, and new knowledge that they apply not only in their enterprises but also in their daily lives.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Quarterly revenue, adoption of practices, use of knowledge, changes in groups before and after.

KEY LESSONS

The learning-by-doing process was impactful: the local monitors saw that if they took care of the mangrove, there were larger fish, and that resulted in benefits not only in terms of money, but also in terms of landscape management.

Stakeholders' Attitudes and Behaviors Changed

ASSUMPTION

If members of the enterprises adopt good practices through the opportunity of biotrade economic alternatives, they recognize the importance of biodiversity for their livelihoods and integrate social, environmental and economic aspects into their enterprises.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

The application of best practices, the use of business models, opinions on the biodiversity resources they use in their enterprises.

KEY LESSONS

By linking the generation of evidence for decision making, governance spaces and technical-economic support, a change of attitude towards the adoption of good social, environmental, and business practices is achieved.

Threat Reduction or Restoration

ASSUMPTION

Overfishing is reduced.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Change towards good fishing practices and resources (mangrove forests, reefs).

KEY LESSONS

Work with community leaders and with evidence to promote the change to good practices, adopting regulations dictated by fishing norms: closed seasons, fishing gear.

Biodiversity Conservation

ASSUMPTION

Improve ecosystems and communities that make use of coastal marine resources by improving their livelihoods through biotrade.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Resource status, income, technical evidence of marketable major species in high biodiversity sites.

KEY LESSONS

If we have contributed to improving landscape and species management and community livelihoods, we have contributed to reducing threats to biodiversity and therefore to its conservation.

Photo Credit: Caribe Pesca

Mejorando los medios de subsistencia mediante la promoción de actividades de biocomercio

Zulma Ricord de Mendoza, Zelma Larios Murillo

EL SALVADOR / CENTROAMERICA REGIONAL

Tipos de Empresas

- Pesca sostenible
- Miel de manglar
- Turismo de la Naturaleza

Estrategia de empresa de conservación

El Proyecto Regional de Biodiversidad Costera mejora los medios de vida y reduce las amenazas a los ecosistemas marinos costeros en El Salvador, Honduras y Guatemala, al abrir nuevas oportunidades económicas basadas en manejo sustentable de los recursos naturales. En concreto, el proyecto promueve el biocomercio, mejora de gobernanza, la gestión del paisaje y la comunicación y la inclusión social como estrategias para lograr la prosperidad local en los ecosistemas costeros transfronterizos de Guatemala, Honduras y El Salvador.

TEORÍA DEL CAMBIO

Apoyo a las empresas de conservación → **Condiciones favorables para las empresas** → **Beneficios obtenidos por las partes interesadas** → **Cambio en el comportamiento y actitud de las partes interesadas** → **Amenazas reducidas para la biodiversidad (o su restauración)** → **Conservación de la biodiversidad**

ACTIVIDADES

Capacitar más de 1,500 personas en temas de asociatividad, turismo local, administración de pequeños negocios, cooperativismo, impactos de cambio climatico, buenas prácticas de pesca y un enfoque de género; formar pequeñas cajas de ahorros; Presentar evidencia de beneficios de manejar bien los recursos naturales; desarrollar cadenas de valor; cash for work para restauración de manglares/ desazolve de canales, medición de captura de CO_2.

Condiciones favorables para las empresas

SUPOSICIÓN

Mujeres y jóvenes participan en las empresas, hay una cultura de asociatividad y cooperativismo, y los leyes incentivan el buen manejo de bosques como manglares.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA

Participación de mujeres en puestos de liderazgo y la toma de decisiones sobre ecosistemas y especies.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES

Incluir mujeres y jóvenes mejora la efectividad de las empresas: Mujeres hacen un trabajo importante en la pesca/la comercialización y los jóvenes llevan mejor manejo de redes sociales tecnológicas.

Beneficios obtenidos por las partes interesadas

SUPOSICIÓN

Capacitaciones y buenas prácticas resultan en mayor empoderamiento, seguridad, liderazgo y ingreso para mujeres y otros miembros de los emprendimientos, aumento en la autovaloración como personas útiles en sus familias y comunidades, y nuevos conocimientos que aplican no solo en su emprendimiento sino en su vida diaria.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA

Los ingresos trimestralmente, la adopción de las prácticas, el uso del conocimiento, los cambios en los grupos el antes y después.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES

El proceso de aprender haciendo fue impactante: los encargados locales del monitoreo veían que si ellos cuidan el manglar, habían peces de tamaño más grande, y eso resultó en beneficios no sólo de dinero, pero de manejo del paisaje.

Cambio en el comportamiento y actitud de las partes interesadas

SUPOSICIÓN

Si los miembros de los emprendimientos adoptan buenas prácticas a través de la oportunidad de alternativas económicas de biocomercio, , reconocen la importancia de la biodiversidad para sus medios de vida e integran aspectos sociales, ambientales y económicos en sus emprendimientos.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA

La aplicación de buenas prácticas, el uso de modelos empresariales, opiniones sobres los recursos de biodiversidad que usan en sus emprendimientos.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES

Vinculando la generación de evidencia para toma de decisiones, espacios de gobernanza y apoyo técnico-económico, se logra un cambio de actitud hacia la adopción de buenas prácticas sociales, ambientales y empresariales.

Amenazas reducidas para la biodiversidad (o su restauración)

SUPOSICIÓN

La sobreexplotación pesquera es reducida.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA

El cambio hacia buenas prácticas pesqueras y hacia sus recursos (bosques de manglar, arrecifes).

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES

Trabajar con líderes de la comunidades y con evidencia propician el cambio a buenas prácticas, adoptando regulaciones dictadas por la normatividad pesquera: vedas, aperos pesqueros.

Conservación de la biodiversidad

SUPOSICIÓN

Mejorar los ecosistemas y comunidades que hacen uso de los recursos marino costeros mejorando sus medios de vida a través del biocomercio.

QUÉ SE MONITOREA

Estado de recursos, ingresos, evidencia técnica de especies de mayor comercialización en sitios de alta biodiversidad.

APRENDIZAJES CLAVES

Si hemos contribuido a mejorar el manejo de paisaje y especies, y medios de vida de las comunidades, hemos contribuido a disminuir las amenazas a la biodiversidad y por tanto a su conservación.

Photo Credit: Caribe Pesca

USAID FROM THE AMERICAN PEOPLE

Communities and the private sector work together to shift norms around sustainable fishing practices

MADAGASCAR

Tiana Rahagalala, Ny Aina Andrianarivelo, Sarah Gaines, URI CRC; Etienne Berthelot & Sophia Rakotoharimalala WCS; Jean-Aimé Razafindra-Paul, Blue Ventures; Tianome Andriantsalama, MIHARI

MIHARI | blue ventures beyond conservation | THE UNIVERSITY OF RHODE ISLAND GRADUATE SCHOOL OF OCEANOGRAPHY | CRC COASTAL RESOURCES CENTER | WCS

Enterprise Types

- Small scale fisheries value chains
- Handicrafts
- Ecotourism
- Seaweed farming
- Crab farming
- Cacao
- Honey

Conservation Enterprise Approach

USAID Riake works with coastal communities and private sector partners to improve sustainable fishing and harvest practices, increase equity and transparency along value chains, and increase benefits to enterprise participants.

THEORY OF CHANGE

Support Conservation Enterprises → **Enabling Conditions in Place for Enterprises** → **Benefits Realized by Stakeholders** → **Stakeholders' Attitudes and Behaviors Changed** → **Threat Reduction or Restoration** → **Biodiversity Conservation**

Support Conservation Enterprises

ACTIVITIES

Small scale fisheries – formalization and training of fishers cooperatives & some associations, partnerships with private sector, feasibility studies, communication campaigns to stakeholders, financial support).
Women's ecotourism association – development of tourism infrastructures
Seaweed farming – training on leadership by and for fisherwomen, connecting to network of brokers during fairs.

Enabling Conditions in Place for Enterprises

ASSUMPTION

Existing good governance practices, willingness to engage in savings opportunities, and connections to private sector partners are key to successful enterprises in Madagascar.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

The officialized and applied Dina (local-level codes considered 'customary law' in Madagascar) and annual Dina compliance measures.

KEY LESSONS

Have a private sector entity that is international (to export) and at least one national to help link with market linkages. If good governance is not in place in the area (e.g. clear LMMA boundary) you cannot proceed with value chain work until its improved. If good governance is not in place in the area (e.g. clear LMMA boundary) you cannot proceed with value chain work until it's improved,

Benefits Realized by Stakeholders

ASSUMPTION

A combination of benefits best supports rural communities, including increased income, access to insurance, savings opportunities, and access to schools. Certifications will be used to finance community services in the future.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Partners create a data profile for communities at the beginning of the activity, survey over the course of the value chain activity, financial inclusion, etc.

KEY LESSONS

LMMA was able to contribute to salary for teachers and support school infrastructure.

Stakeholders' Attitudes and Behaviors Changed

ASSUMPTION

Benefits encourage participants to engage in Marine Protected Area (MPA) management & improved governance practices
Community norms around quality fish shift to be more sustainable (appropriate size, gear) and buyers only accept these quality fish.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Survey and Patrol data.

KEY LESSONS

Engaging people in conservation in new ways (e.g., science monitoring) has started shifting norms.
Creating venues to share and discuss norms and costs along the value chain can increase equity and reduce costs for all actors.

Threat Reduction or Restoration

ASSUMPTION

Increased community understanding of their fish stocks & shifting norms around catch size reduces overfishing and overharvesting of marine resources, and aquaculture activities will encourage restoration of marine and coastal habitats

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Catch landing, including fish size, monitored by trained data collectors. Profiling of the fishers representative for value chain to understand gear usage among other key indicators of threat reduction.

Biodiversity Conservation

ASSUMPTION

Fisheries are more diverse and higher in biomass and coral reefs and mangroves are restored.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Health status of key habitats and ecological monitoring (participatory monitoring or scientist monitoring).

KEY LESSONS

Engaging community members in the monitoring of their natural resources helps them understand the current status of the biodiversity (their fishing stocks) and appreciate the need to shift fishing and harvesting norms.

Photo Credit: Madagascar Riake

Collective beekeeping and mushroom producer groups adopting sustainable practices increases access to finance and protected areas, improves prices, and reduces negative impacts on biodiversity

USAID
FROM THE AMERICAN PEOPLE

TANZANIA

Romanus Mwakimata, Mwanaidi Mussa, Valeria Shirima

RTI INTERNATIONAL

ADAP ASSOCIATION POUR LE DÉVELOPPEMENT DES AIRES PROTÉGÉES

Enterprise Types

- Beekeeping
- Mushroom gathering
- Fruit and vegetable farming

Conservation Enterprise Approach

Tuhifadhi Maliasili aims to conserve biodiversity by supporting sustainable beekeeping, wild mushroom collection, fruits and vegetable farming by forming producer groups and VSLAs, providing training on sustainable practices and access to infrastructure/inputs, and advocating with conservation authorities to ease producer group access to protected areas. Sustainable practices improve prices and the collective voice of producer groups can increase access to market information, which also improves prices.

THEORY OF CHANGE

Support conservation enterprises → **Enabling condition in place for enterprise** → **Benefits realized by stakeholders** → **Stakeholders' attitudes and behaviors changed** → **Threat reduction or restoration** → **Biodiversity Conservation**

ACTIVITIES

-Trainings on sustainable mushroom, beekeeping, fruit and vegetable farming
-Financial linkage through engagement of NMB Bank Public Company Limited (PLC) - Community Microfinance Groups
-Saving groups
-Market linkages to local, regional, and international markets
-Business advisory services through meetings and peer to peer learning.
-Improve infrastructure such as beekeeping equipments (log hives), and baskets, sealing machines and packaging materials, and solar dryers for mushroom pickers

Enabling condition in place for enterprise

ASSUMPTION

Women's producer groups access finance through customized bank programs and are registered to regulatory authorities to meet market standards. Simplified permitting processes and reduced entry and camping fees facilitate access to protected areas for beekeeper and mushroom collector associations.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Monitoring the interest rate repayment schedules to ensure they are affordable and the status of registration.

KEY LESSONS

Producers need to operate collectively to increase the effectiveness of advocating for reduced costs of inputs.

Benefits realized by stakeholders

ASSUMPTION

Forming a producer group increases social capital among producers and with value chain actors, adopting sustainable practices enable beekeepers to receive higher prices for their honey, and enable mushroom collectors to access quality collecting areas in protected areas. Use of organic baskets increases shelf life of mushrooms.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Tracking enterprise production levels, costs, and prices/unit received.

KEY LESSONS

Forming producer cooperatives is crucial as some government forests wont allow individual producers access to collect NFTPs.

Stakeholders' attitudes and behaviors changed

ASSUMPTION

Mushroom collectors use organic baskets instead of nylon and don't uproot the mushrooms. Beekeepers adopt sustainable practices like shifting from tree bark hive to log or modern hives and not using smoke. Both producer groups connect the value of biodiversity to their increase in income.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Number of beekeepers adopting sustainable practices, number of mushroom pickers using organic baskets.

KEY LESSONS

Memorandum of understanding between government conservation agencies and beekeepers and mushroom pickers is important for easing access to protected areas.

Threat reduction or restoration

ASSUMPTION

Replacement of tree bark hives with log or modern hives reduces deforestation, friendly harvesting practices reduces bee loss and fires, and replacement of nylon baskets with organic baskets reduces animal death by ingestion.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Number of adopted log and box hives and amount of hard materials (plastic/nylon) found in protected areas.

KEY LESSONS

Adoption of sustainable practices by beekeepers and mushroom collectors builds trust with local conservation authorities, which in turn, reinforces access to protected areas.

Biodiversity Conservation

ASSUMPTION

Recovery of biodiversity species (Trees, bees, fauna in parks) and miombo ecosystem.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Vegetation baseline survey and the recovery rate based on midterm transect survey.

KEY LESSONS

The recovery rate of the miombo ecosystem is very fast.

Photo Credit: Madagascar Riake

Linking communities to rattan export and strengthening the sustainable practices of Luc Dong Construction and Trading Company Ltd.

USAID FROM THE AMERICAN PEOPLE

VIETNAM

Tuong Nguyen (PPP Specialist), Huong Nguyen (Sustainable NTFP Specialist), and Thong Nguyen (CFM Director), DAI

LỤC ĐÔNG

DAI

Enterprise Type

- Sustainable rattan

Conservation Enterprise Approach

The Sustainable Forest Management (SFM) activity supports farmers to sustainably grow and harvest rattan through Economic Cooperative Groups (ECGs) while simultaneously supporting an enterprise, Luc Dong, to meet sustainability standards and link their product to national and international markets, legally. SFM also supports the Community Forest Management Boards (CFMBs) to monitor the sustainable use of community forests and ensure rattan is harvested and sold legally.

THEORY OF CHANGE

Support Conservation Enterprises → Enabling Conditions in Place for Enterprises → Benefits Realized by Stakeholders → Stakeholders' Attitudes and Behaviors Changed → Threat Reduction or Restoration → Biodiversity Conservation

Support Conservation Enterprises

ACTIVITIES

The project supports both community farmers and the company, Luc Dong, who buys rattan from the community and sells to export markets. Work with the community includes the establishment of Economic Cooperative Groups and technical training to farmers. Work with Luc Dong focuses on linking to external markets, supporting the enterprise to sell higher volumes to an export company. SFM also supports CFMBs to monitor the adherence of village conventions and to provide documents related to rattan harvest for legal transport from the community.

Enabling Conditions in Place for Enterprises

ASSUMPTION

Members of ECGs have secure and sustainable access to rattan from community-managed forests and can meet the high market demand for the production of Luc Dong's goods and services.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Informal monitoring or rural appraisals through discussions with communities.

KEY LESSONS

The high market demand, limited raw materials, and high competition with other enterprises may damage the resource, so it will be important to track the unintended consequences of this value chain, even if done legally and sustainably through Luc Dong.

Benefits Realized by Stakeholders

ASSUMPTION

The ECG structure allows cash benefits from selling rattan raw materials to be distributed equally while also reinvesting in the ECG (e.g. covering costs of equipment for production expansion, and allowance for the management board). Luc Dong will follow standards & criteria for buying raw materials and pay more for sustainably harvested rattan.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

Focus group discussions / interviews
Purchase price of sustainable rattan.

KEY LESSONS

Luc Dong pays $2 for one ton of raw rattan to the respective CFMB which is evidence that the Luc Dong recognizes role of the CFMB, especially in helping Luc Dong to comply with regulations (e.g., transportation, natural resource tax).

Stakeholders' Attitudes and Behaviors Changed

ASSUMPTION

ECGs members appreciate the added income they receive from sustainable rattan harvest and no longer engage in unsustainable practices. Simultaneously, community patrolling teams strengthen their patrols and collaborate with forest rangers, local authorities and CFMBs for more effective enforcement.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

# of patrols and # of incidents on patrols, documented in the community patrol log.

KEY LESSONS

Through the various modalities they engage with SFM, communities have changed their perception of forests as the state's property to forests as a community asset, and that has increased their commitment to sustainable forest management.

Threat Reduction or Restoration

ASSUMPTION

ECGs members will apply and adhere to sustainable rattan harvesting practices which will be more closely monitored by the CFMB's patrolling teams. This will contribute to maintaining the natural forest habitats and reduce deforestation in community-managed forests.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

CFMBs monitor the sustainability of rattan harvest and legality of trade and export.

Biodiversity Conservation

ASSUMPTION

Community-managed forests and the biodiversity within them are healthy, support carbon sequestration, and provide a sustainable source of livelihoods for communities.

WHAT IS MEASURED & HOW

CFMBs conduct forest inventory by the end of each SFM planning cycle (every 5 years) that can demonstrate the changes in forest health and carbon stock of community forests.

KEY LESSONS

Rattan harvesters will implement sustainable practices provided that they have the right capacity, and the buyer, Luc Dong, adopts biodiversity conservation friendly standards and criteria with better revenue and market access (e.g., both domestic and international market).

Photo Credit: Luc Dong